

Website hosting SSH commands for EC2

The below steps are the same for MacOS, Linux, Ubuntu and Windows.

The difference:

1. For MacOS, Linux or Ubuntu: you can work directly on your terminal.
2. For Windows: You need to install Git Bash Terminal (<https://gitforwindows.org/> you can download it from here).

Before doing the below steps, make sure you start an **Ubuntu** instance and create a keypair and remember the file path to that keypair.

Connect to EC2

`cd path to your pem file. If your pem file is inside downloads, hit cd downloads, then the below step.`

`chmod 400 keypair.pem (the name of your keypair. If it is cloud, write chmod400 cloud.pem)`

Makes your key file secure so you can use it.

`ssh -i keypair.pem ubuntu@EC2_PUBLIC_IP`

Logs you into your EC2 server.

Update the Server

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y
```

Updates everything on your server to the latest version.

Install Nginx

```
sudo apt install nginx -y
```

Installs the Nginx web server.

```
sudo systemctl enable nginx
```

Makes Nginx start automatically whenever the server starts.

```
sudo systemctl start nginx
```

Starts the web server.

Upload Your Website Files (from a different terminal. NOT in the SSH terminal, do this step in a different terminal window)

```
scp -i key.pem /PATH/TO/YOUR/FILES/* ubuntu@EC2_PUBLIC_IP:~/
```

(you can ask chatgpt if you do not understand how to find the path to your files. It will customize the command for you.)

Uploads your website files (HTML, CSS, etc.) to your server's home folder.

Replace `/PATH/TO/YOUR/FILES/*` with the actual folder path on your device where your website files are saved.

Example: `/Users/yourname/Desktop/website/*`

Go back to the SSH terminal

Remove Default Nginx Page (after SSH)

```
sudo rm -rf /var/www/html/*
```

Deletes the default “Welcome to Nginx” page so your website can show.

Move Your Files to the Web Folder

```
sudo mv ~/index.html /var/www/html/
```

Moves your main HTML file.

```
sudo mv ~/style.css /var/www/html/
```

Moves your CSS file.

Do the same for any other files you uploaded.

Set Permissions

```
sudo chown -R www-data:www-data /var/www/html
```

Gives Nginx ownership of your website files.

```
sudo chmod -R 755 /var/www/html
```

Allows Nginx to read the files properly.

Restart Nginx

```
sudo systemctl restart nginx
```

Restarts the web server so your website becomes active.

Open your EC2 public IP. Make sure you do <http://yourip>. NOT HTTPS.